Academic Passage

Smartphones and Sleep

סמארטפונים ושינה

1 Today, almost everyone has a smartphone. People use their phones to talk, study, shop, and watch videos. However, many people also use their phones in bed, just before they go to sleep. Scientists say that this habit can affect the quality of our sleep.

2 There are two main reasons why phones cause sleep problems. The first reason is the blue light from the screen. This light makes the brain think that it is still daytime. The second reason is that phones keep the mind active. Messages, games, and social media make it hard to relax.

3 Blue light reduces the amount of melatonin in the body. Melatonin is a natural hormone that helps us fall asleep. When there is less melatonin, people need more time to fall asleep, and they often wake up during the night.

4 Poor sleep has many negative results. People who do not sleep enough often feel tired and nervous during the day. They also make more mistakes at work and at school. In the long term, lack of sleep can increase the risk of health problems, such as heart disease and diabetes.

5 Teenagers and young adults are the group that is affected the most. A recent study found that students who used their phones in bed slept about one hour less than students who did not. It appears that young people find it especially difficult to put their phones away.

6 Experts suggest several simple solutions. For example, people can stop using screens one hour before bedtime. They can also turn on night mode, which reduces blue light, or leave the phone in another room. Reading a paper book instead of a screen is another good idea.

7 In conclusion, smartphones are useful tools, but they can damage our sleep. By changing a few habits, people can sleep better and feel healthier.

מילים שימושיות

smartphone – סמארטפון
phones – טלפונים
shop – לקנות
videos – סרטונים
bed – מיטה
scientists – מדענים
habit – הרגל
quality – איכות
sleep – שינה
reasons – סיבות
blue – כחול
screen – מסך
daytime – שעות היום
mind – מוח; תודעה
active – פעיל

Vocabulary Use the paragraph number

1. Paragraph 1 Find a word that means **הרגל**

_____

2. Paragraph 1 What does **quality** mean?
   a) מקום
   b) זמן
   c) איכות
   d) כמות

3. Paragraph 2 Find a word that means **להירגע**

_____

4. Paragraph 2 What does **reasons** mean?
   a) תוצאות
   b) פתרונות
   c) סיבות
   d) הודעות

5. Paragraph 3 Find a word that means **מפחית; מקטין**

_____

6. Paragraph 4 Find a word that means **שליליות**

_____

7. Paragraph 4 What does **lack of** mean?
   a) סוג של
   b) הרבה
   c) חוסר
   d) במקום

8. Paragraph 5 Find a word that means **נראה ש- (מופיע כפועל)**

_____

9. Paragraph 6 Find a word that means **מציעים (פועל)**

_____

10. Paragraph 7 What does **damage** mean?
    - **a)** לבדוק
    - **b)** למדוד
    - **c)** לשפר
    - **d)** לפגוע; להזיק

Comprehension Questions

Read only the paragraph in the question

1. Paragraph 1 When do many people use their phones, according to paragraph 1?
   מתי אנשים רבים משתמשים בטלפון, לפי פסקה 1?
   - **a)** during the night only
   - **b)** only at work
   - **c)** in bed, just before they go to sleep

2. Paragraph 2 What are the two main reasons why phones cause sleep problems?
   מהן שתי הסיבות העיקריות לכך שטלפונים גורמים לבעיות שינה?

   Circle 2: phones are expensive | people talk too much | phones keep the mind active | the screen is too small | the blue light from the screen

   _____ _____

3. Paragraph 3 What is melatonin?
   מה זה מלטונין?
   - **a)** a natural hormone that helps us fall asleep
   - **b)** a sleep problem
   - **c)** a kind of blue light

4. Paragraph 3 Give two results of having less melatonin.
   תני שתי תוצאות של פחות מלטונין בגוף.

   Circle 2: people feel hungry | people need more time to fall asleep | people use their phones less | people wake up during the night

   _____ _____

5. Paragraph 4 Give two negative results of poor sleep.
   תני שתי תוצאות שליליות של שינה גרועה.

   Circle 4: a higher risk of health problems | people feel tired | people sleep more at night | people make more mistakes | people feel nervous | people use their phones less

   _____ _____ _____ _____

6. Paragraph 4 Give two examples of health problems.

תני שתי דוגמאות לבעיות בריאות.

Circle 2: heart disease | diabetes | headaches | stress | blue light

_____ _____

7. Paragraph 5 How much less did students who used their phones in bed sleep?

בכמה פחות ישנו סטודנטים שהשתמשו בטלפון במיטה?

a) about one hour

b) about two hours

c) about ten minutes

8. Paragraph 6 Give two examples of solutions that experts suggest.

תני שתי דוגמאות לפתרונות שמומחים מציעים.

Circle 4: buy a new phone | read a paper book | leave the phone in another room | stop using screens one hour before bedtime | turn on night mode | drink coffee at night

_____ _____ _____ _____

9. Paragraph 7 What is the writer's main conclusion?

מהי המסקנה העיקרית של הכותב?

a) Blue light is good for the brain.

b) People should never use smartphones.

c) Phones are useful, but changing habits helps us sleep better.